

FREE STARTER KIT

The Quiet Wealth Starter Kit

A 7-Day Money Reset, a one-page Budget Template, and a Debt Escape Map.

No hype. No jargon. Just the first quiet steps.

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Hello, friend.

I'm Warren. I'm seventy years old, and I've made just about every money mistake a man can make. I've carried credit card debt that kept me up at night. I've bought things to impress people I didn't even like. And I've learned, slowly, that wealth isn't loud. It's quiet. It's the absence of panic when the car breaks down.

This kit is not going to make you rich by Friday. Anyone who promises that is selling you something dishonest. What it *will* do is help you stop the bleeding, see your money clearly for the first time in years, and take seven small steps that compound.

Each day takes about fifteen minutes. That's it. You don't need a finance degree, a six-figure salary, or an app. You need a pen, this kit, and a little honesty with yourself.

Start tomorrow morning with Day 1. Don't read ahead and do nothing — that's the old way. One day, one step.

I'm glad you're here.

Warren

WHAT'S INSIDE

Three tools. One quiet plan.

Part I — The 7-Day Money Reset

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One small task each day. Fifteen minutes. By Sunday you'll know exactly where you stand.

Part II — The One-Page Budget Template

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The 50 / 30 / 20 method, simplified. Print it, fill it in pencil, pin it to the fridge.

Part III — The Debt Escape Map

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List every debt once, choose your exit route, and never wonder "where do I even start?" again.

How to use this kit

- Do the Reset first — Days 1 through 7, in order.
- On Day 5 you'll use the Budget Template. On Day 6, the Debt Map.
- The two worksheets are on light pages so they print cleanly.

Look it in the eye.

Most money stress doesn't come from the numbers. It comes from not knowing the numbers. Today we end that. No fixing, no judging — just looking.

"You can't steer a ship while refusing to look at the water."

Today's 15 minutes

- ☐ Open every bank account and credit card you have. Yes, all of them.
- ☐ Write down each balance on one piece of paper — cash on the left, debts on the right.
- ☐ Subtract debts from cash. Circle the number. That's your starting point, not your worth.
- ☐ Say out loud: "This is just where I'm starting." Then put the paper away.

Find the leaks.

Small, forgettable charges sink more households than big purchases ever will. Today you'll hunt the quiet leaks: subscriptions, fees, and the things you forgot you were paying for.

"A small leak will sink a great ship. Franklin said it. Your bank statement proves it."

Today's 15 minutes

- ☐ Pull up last month's statement and read every line, top to bottom.
- ☐ Highlight every subscription, membership, and bank fee.
- ☐ Cancel at least one thing today. Just one. Most people find \$20–\$80 a month.
- ☐ Write the monthly total of what you cancelled — that's your first pay raise.

Know your real income.

Not your salary — your *take-home*. The number that actually lands in your account each month. Every plan you'll ever make is built on this one figure.

“Plans built on gross income are built on sand.”

Today's 15 minutes

- ☐ Find your last two pay stubs or deposits.
- ☐ Write down what actually hits your account each month, after taxes and deductions.
- ☐ If your income varies, average the last three months and use the lower side.
- ☐ Keep this number — you'll need it on Day 5.

The \$500 wall.

Before debt payoff, before investing, before anything — you need a small wall between you and life's surprises. Not six months of expenses. Just \$500 to start. That wall is what keeps a flat tire from becoming new credit card debt.

"An emergency fund isn't about money. It's about sleeping through the night."

Today's 15 minutes

- ☐ Open (or pick) a savings account that is *not* attached to your debit card.
- ☐ Move something into it today — \$5 counts. The habit matters more than the amount.
- ☐ Set an automatic weekly transfer, even a small one, for every payday.
- ☐ Name the account "The Wall" or "Sleep Money." Naming it protects it.

Give every dollar a job.

Today you'll fill in the Budget Template on page 12. We use the 50/30/20 rule because it's simple enough to survive real life: 50% needs, 30% wants, 20% saving and debt payoff. Pencil, not pen — budgets are living things.

"A budget isn't a cage. It's permission to spend without guilt."

Today's 15 minutes

- ☐ Print the Budget Template (page 12), or copy it onto paper.
- ☐ Write your Day-3 take-home number at the top.
- ☐ Fill in Needs first, then Wants, then the 20% line. Use pencil.
- ☐ If the numbers don't fit — that's information, not failure. Adjust the Wants first.

Don't aim for a perfect budget. Aim for an honest one. Perfect comes around month three.

Draw your escape map.

Debt feels like fog — heavy and shapeless. Today we turn the fog into a map. You'll list every debt once on the Debt Escape Map (page 14) and choose one of two exit routes.

"You don't fight fog. You draw a map and walk out of it."

Today's 15 minutes

- ☐ Print the Debt Escape Map (page 14).
- ☐ List every debt: who you owe, the balance, the interest rate, the minimum payment.
- ☐ Choose your route: **Avalanche** (highest rate first — saves the most money) or **Snowball** (smallest balance first — fastest wins). Either works. Pick the one you'll stick with.
- ☐ Number your debts in payoff order. Pay minimums on all, and aim every spare dollar at #1.

Set it, then live your life.

The final step is making the system run without your willpower. Willpower has bad days. Automation doesn't. Fifteen minutes today buys you calm for months.

“Quiet wealth is mostly this: good decisions, automated, left alone.”

Today's 15 minutes

- ☐ Set up autopay for at least the minimum on every debt — never pay a late fee again.
- ☐ Automate your savings transfer (Day 4) if you haven't.
- ☐ Put a 20-minute “money check-in” on your calendar, same day every month.
- ☐ Tonight: close the laptop, take a walk, and notice that nothing is on fire. That's the feeling we're building.

The One-Page Budget Template

The 50/30/20 budget divides your monthly take-home pay into three buckets. It's forgiving by design — a budget you can keep beats a perfect one you abandon by the 9th.

50% — Needs

Rent or mortgage, groceries, utilities, insurance, transport, minimum debt payments. The things life genuinely requires.

30% — Wants

Eating out, streaming, hobbies, travel. Not the enemy — just a guest with a budget.

20% — Future You

Savings, your \$500 wall, and every dollar of *extra* debt payoff beyond the minimums. This is the bucket that changes your life. If 20% isn't possible yet, start with 5% — the direction matters more than the speed.

The worksheet on the next page is intentionally light-colored. Print it, grab a pencil, and fill it in once a month — ideally the first Sunday.

Monthly Budget — Month: _____

Monthly take-home pay: \$ _____ · 50% = \$ _____ 30% = \$ _____ 20% = \$ _____

NEEDS (TARGET 50%)	PLANNED	ACTUAL	WANTS (TARGET 30%)
Rent / Mortgage	\$	\$	Dining out \$ _____ / \$ _____
Groceries	\$	\$	Subscriptions \$ _____ / \$ _____
Utilities & phone	\$	\$	Hobbies & fun \$ _____ / \$ _____
Insurance	\$	\$	Shopping \$ _____ / \$ _____
Transport / gas	\$	\$	Travel fund \$ _____ / \$ _____
Minimum debt payments	\$	\$	Other \$ _____ / \$ _____
Other need	\$	\$	Wants total \$ _____ / \$ _____
Needs total	\$	\$	

FUTURE YOU (TARGET 20%)	PLANNED	ACTUAL	MONTH-END REVIEW
Emergency fund ("The Wall")	\$	\$	Did money run out before the month? Y / N
Extra debt payoff	\$	\$	Biggest surprise: _____
Savings / investing	\$	\$	One change for next month: _____
Future You total	\$	\$	

Pencil, not pen. A budget is a living document — version 3 is always better than version 1.

The Debt Escape Map

There are two proven routes out of debt. Both work. The best one is whichever you'll actually follow.

Route A — The Avalanche

Pay minimums on everything; aim every spare dollar at the **highest interest rate** first. Mathematically optimal — you pay the least total interest.

Best if: you're motivated by efficiency.

Route B — The Snowball

Pay minimums on everything; aim every spare dollar at the **smallest balance** first. You get quick wins, and wins build momentum.

Best if: you've started and quit before.

Three rules of the map

- Never miss a minimum payment — automate them all (Day 7).
- One target at a time. Spreading extra money across five debts feels busy and changes nothing.
- When a debt dies, roll its entire payment onto the next target. That's where the speed comes from.

My Debt Escape Map

My route: ☐ Avalanche (highest rate first) ☐ Snowball (smallest balance first)

#	WHO I OWE	BALANCE	RATE %	MIN. PAYMENT	PAID OFF! (DATE)
		\$		\$	
		\$		\$	
		\$		\$	
		\$		\$	
		\$		\$	
		\$		\$	
		\$		\$	
		\$		\$	
		\$		\$	
		\$		\$	
	Total	\$		\$	

My extra attack money each month: \$ _____ (from cancelled subscriptions, Day 2, and your 20% bucket)

Target #1 is: _____ **Estimated payoff month:** _____

When Target #1 falls, draw a line through it, celebrate quietly, and roll its full payment onto Target #2.

Where this road goes.

If you did the seven days — honestly, with a pencil — you're already ahead of most people. You know your number. The leaks are plugged. The wall is rising. The map is drawn.

Wealth that lasts is built quietly: small moves, repeated, left alone to compound.

Keep the rhythm. Twenty minutes, once a month, same day. That's the whole maintenance plan.

Want to go deeper?

The next step after the Reset is **The Quiet Wealth Blueprint** — my full step-by-step system for going from "stable" to "building": emergency funds beyond \$500, beginner investing without the casino mentality, and the exact order of operations I wish I'd known at 30.

You'll find it on my page. No pressure — the kit you're holding works on its own.

Reply to any of my emails if you get stuck. I read them.

Warren

THE FINE PRINT

Disclaimer

This kit is for educational and informational purposes only and does not constitute financial, investment, tax, or legal advice. Warren Mitchell is a fictional character and content persona; the material reflects general personal-finance principles, not professional counsel. Everyone's situation is different — consider speaking with a qualified financial professional before making significant financial decisions. No outcome is guaranteed.

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Slow is smooth. Smooth is fast.

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